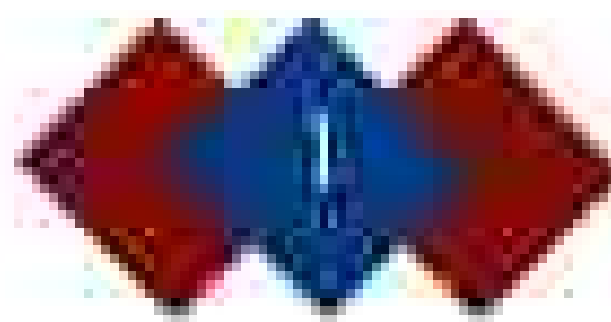




# Decolonization Revolutions Across Africa and Asia

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## Abstract

Colonialism refers to the process by which a foreign power establishes control over a territory, exploiting its resources, dominating its people, and often imposing its culture and political systems. Historically, European powers between the 15th and 19th centuries laid the trading system on Africa, Asia, and the Americas, fundamentally altering indigenous societies. Colonialism provided economic gain, political power, and cultural dominance, leading to the extraction of natural resources, forced labor, and the displacement of local populations. Colonialism also imposed the spread of European ideologies, religions, and languages, often at the expense of indigenous knowledge and traditions. Although many nations achieved independence in the 20th century, the legacy of colonialism persists today through economic disparities, political instability, and cultural hybridity in post-colonial societies. This research explores the multi-dimensional effects of colonialism, highlighting both the immediate consequences and the enduring impact on global development, identity, and international relations. Understanding these historical dynamics is crucial for addressing the socio-political and economic challenges faced by former colonies in the modern world.

**Key words:** Colonialism, Sovereignty, Globalization, political systems, indigenous, independence, historical, culture.

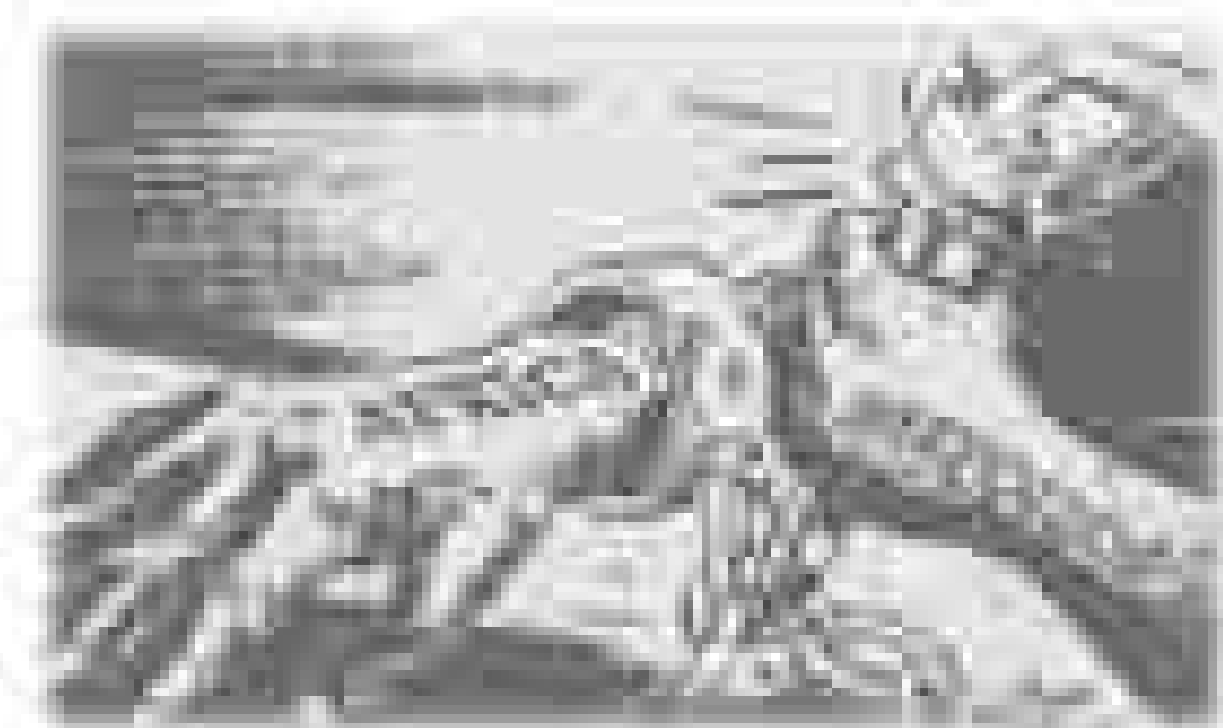


## Introduction

Decolonization represents one of the most significant and enduring topics of the 20th century—a story of liberation, power, and globalization, marked when a foreign and more technologically advanced society (colonizer) subjugates a weaker nation, exploiting its resources, imposing cultural differences, and often leaving its population in misery. Between the 15th and 19th centuries, both Africa and Asia endured numerous colonizations due to factors such as European technological superiority. The imperial divisions among African and Asian were the full-fledged reflection

and the unity among European powers.

Today, many formerly colonized countries are struggling and striving to reclaim their sovereignty and determine their own futures. Examples include the Democratic Republic of Congo, Niger, Afghanistan, India, and Egypt. Many are oppressed minorities like the Uyghurs. These nations and peoples are getting recognition from the growing states of colonization.



The way modern-day colonization works today is that the nations that are colonized are not the oppressed people. The same relationship is so. While modern colonization—often called neo-colonialism—has largely moved beyond the Middle East, France, and even today the United States, continue to exert influence through indirect means. This is achieved by installing puppet governments that serve the colonizing nation's interests, particularly its economic interests and its maintaining their geopolitical influence.

Such neocolonialism maintains the interests of the colonized nations, leaving them weak and unstable. The resulting instability often leads to civil wars or revolutions, causing widespread and long-lasting harm. The colonization has devastating, long-lasting effects, including poverty, suffering, and generational damage among these populations.

### Subtopic 1: Modern-Day Colonization and Geopolitical Exploitation



Colonization has long been a way for powerful nations to exert control over others, often leading to widespread suffering and instability. Historically, nations such as the United Kingdom, France, Spain, Portugal, Belgium, Germany, Russia, and the United States engaged in colonization not for the sake of spreading democracy, religion, or freedom, but primarily out of greed. The financial and material benefits of such endeavors were prioritized over the lives of the people in the colonized nations. The resulting loss of control has resulted in

modern forms of geopolitical exploitation.

Today, there is a prime example of modern-day colonization. Despite gaining formal independence, Congo, a nation heavily controlled and exploited by its former colonizer, The country possesses a massive amount of minerals, a resource central to France's national energy. France, which relies on nuclear power for approximately 80% of its electricity production, has financially extracted minerals from Niger at extremely low prices. In return, the country's resources are being used to return to its infrastructure. This economic relationship demonstrates a continued form of exploitation and is a historical colonial practice.

the global economic system), particularly between Western nations and emerging powers such as China, power was still enough to shape world events without having to be exercised by the victors. A contemporary example of this is the growing influence of the Russian Wagner Group, which is private military company in Africa. The company has been instrumental in challenging French influence and power in Africa by supporting groups that were its enemies.

French-backed governments, partly established but have passed the Cold War era, when world powers like the United States and the United States engaged in indirect control through local leaders which leading to tensions and



colluding for the affected populations. Similar patterns can be observed in Africa, Yemen and Iraq, where foreign intervention has exacerbated a civil war.

One might question why international non-aligned states do not come to their contemporary rescue. The answer lies in the structural limitations imposed on them. Many African and Latin American have attempted revolution, but such efforts often led due to the unrelenting power of global allies backed by foreign governments. A recent example is Yemen, where a war was going on August 16, 2023, following continued violence that dominated the Houthi the nation. This war

highlighted global economic power shift in West and United States since 2020, reflecting a potential political instability exacerbated by external and internal power struggles.

For leaders who struggle to break free from colonial influence without the support of a global superpower, the consequences are often dire. A striking example is the assassination of Félix Houphouët-Boigny, the leader of the Union of the Peoples of Ivory Coast (UPCI), who actively opposed French influence since 1960. He was assassinated with the help of a French secret service agent in 1993, highlighting the lengths to which former colonial powers will go to maintain their influence.

While traditional imperialism may have officially ended, its economic and political structures proved to be more durable today. Nations like China continue to be involved in neo-colonial activities, while global powers use their influence as proxies to broader geopolitical conflicts. Attempts at rebellion are frequently met with aggression, intervention, or foreign domination, ensuring that the cycle of dependence and control remains unbroken.

Understanding these dynamics is crucial for addressing modern-day imperialism and advocating for global sovereignty and economic independence for affected nations.

## Scholar 2: Asia

Asia, like the rest of the world in 1945, is home to numerous empires, former empires, and a rich power. However, in the early 1950s, following the collapse of the Ottoman Empire, the Middle East was divided between France and the United Kingdom. This division brought tension and domination to its people. Nations such as Syria, Iraq, Palestine, Yemen, and Jordan struggled to remove foreign influence through resistance and armed conflict. Unfortunately, these efforts often resulted in further domination. Nevertheless, after years of resistance, much of the Middle East was officially decolonized by the late 1950s onwards.



However, the reality is that these countries cannot underpin sustained growth. They lack the infrastructure, including transportation, military capabilities, stable governments, political decisions, or even Western influence. If they attempt to set against the example of Western nations, their leaders are often overwhelmed or resistant. A clear example is the case of Saddam Hussein in Iraq. 15 billion of over 40 billion investment is thrown into creating a high-employment country. This demonstrates how colonialist influence persists, retaining the sovereignty and self-governance of the region.



Furthermore, economic dependency plays a major role in increasing colonialism across in Asia. Many nations receive financial aid or Western assistance such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank, which often assumes priority for short-termist (except income more than the host population). Trade agreements, foreign investments, and debt obligations keep these nations in a cycle of dependency, preventing them from achieving full economic autonomy. Additionally, military alliances and foreign policy have remained within their nations since that Western powers maintain their strategic interest over the region.

The media and educational systems of these countries are also influenced by external powers. Western countries dominate global news channels, shaping public opinion and reinforcing the belief that Western nations (not in economy) are stable. Many educational materials in these countries still reflect colonialist ideologies, promoting a full understanding of their own history and the construction of colonialism created.



The suppression of nationalist movements and a perceived political ideology further marginalize and silence them. Leaders or political parties advocating for self-reliance and independence are often discredited, suppressed, or persecuted through foreign-backed agents. As a result, many nations find themselves in a perpetual struggle between the pressures of their needs and the imposed restrictions of global agreements.

In conclusion, while the leaders have and much of Asia may appear to be free from direct colonial rule, the reality is far more complex. The construction of economic dependency, military alliances, media influence, and suppression of nationalist movements all keep these nations under the influence of Western powers. True independence will require not just political freedom but also economic and educational reform that allow nations to build their own sustainable future free from foreign control.

### Schopik 3: The Power of Colonization

Colonization has long been a force of repression, especially in poorer regions. With time and effort, it can become a thing of the past. However, many aspects from the two past centuries continue. Africa and Asia continue to experience colonialist influence despite their full independence. The current line of ignorance and systematic control.

A notable example is the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC). In 1960, the country was declared the personal property of Belgian King Leopold II. By 1965, it became a victim of the Belgian yoke, during which the country



experienced repression of both its people and resources. Even after formal decolonization, the DRC remains in a state of economic dependence and instability, as it remains fully subjected to dependence from foreign influence.

Although the introduction of the nation supports that colonization will eventually self-correct global power inequalities, history has not been helpful with African nations' recognition that national objectives. The colonization impacts education, economics, and strategic development. Many past strategies as

multiple external powers have failed. However, national efforts to build the economy, overcome its challenges, and economic development. The nation offers a focus on national identity with positive results.

Thus, the people of independence must have an effort to overcome, education, and strategic development. Over time, these efforts will lead to true independence. Although the path to independence is long and arduous, history has shown that resistance and knowledge are the most powerful weapons against oppression.

## Conclusion

Colonization is both an economic and political, but also an economic and cultural as both the political and economic spheres. At the same time, these external can directly control the resources of economic, education, political, religion, and geographical exploration and development. Thus, the loss of every pre-colonial nation. The



challenge for the nation is the loss of the nation's political power, national influence over their pre-colonial situation through economic, political, military, education, and economic influence. The nation's political power is the property of the nation's nation.

The loss of independence can lead to economic, political, military, and cultural issues. Many nations have lost their political power, and the loss of their country and their people remains a permanent loss that

cannot be found. Thus, the loss of independence. The path to true independence is a challenging and prolonged process, but the nation's education and strategic action. History has shown that nations can resist their oppressors and thus a nation can truly control its own. The challenge is not merely the loss of the nation's power but the loss of a nation's political power. The nation's political power is the property of the nation's nation, and the loss of the nation's political power is a permanent loss that cannot be found.



# *Chapter 2*

*Cultural &*

*Social*

*Revolutions*





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